

Fade In:

EXT: SPACE - NIGHT

Thousands of years ago...

A blanket of STARDUST spins as the purest of whites as it shoots through the universe of space, stepping over time, leaving particles of dust behind to compress into stars and planets.

The light is a source in and of itself, shape-shifting as it desires.

Stardust, a light being, jumps through black holes to cross great expanses of space in an instant, rapidly approaching a destination.

The blanket of light comes to a halt. Stardust suspends herself between the Earth and the Sun, limiting her glory so as to not destroy the planet Proleum.

The planet Proleum is young. Eight days in celestial time, to be exact.

EXT: PROLEUM - CONT

A beam of particles shoots from Stardust towards the planet. The particles converge into a small humanoid as it approaches the atmosphere.

Her glass humanoid form is unaffected by the gravitational pull of the planet's mass, as well as the viscous forces from the viscous air.

Her glass figure accelerates as it approaches a massive cloud of darkness.

Below the clouds is a desolate land drained of nutrients and color, all centered upon a dark abyss. It's far darker than any black hole.

Four waterfalls pour endlessly into the abyss. Their source is still pure, though their paths have become bleak.

Everything surrounding the abyss is dead. The land and the water.

Dim reflections of the Sun bounce from the planet only to float about aimlessly.

Stardust's glass figure moves without hesitation. She presses on, determined to reach as deep into the abyss as possible.

Stardust passes with speed through the skies.

Then...she loses all motion. An abrupt halt is shattering against her will. A power holds Stardust in place.

She faces one of the waterfalls.

A figure appears before her. A new presence.

A demon named LUCILLE.

It has four limbs and a head, though it remains crouched, hiding teeth. It has distorted features in mockery of a man, with hollow eyes that appear deeper black than the surrounding darkness.

The glass surface of Stardust's body creaks and moans.

LUCILLE

Why have you come? Into the depths
of my power. Into the very heart
of my land.

STARDUST

Nothing is yours. Nothing will be
yours. You will have only nothing
forever. That was your choice.

LUCILLE

Funny. I remember it differently.
We were offered the choice between
sacrificing all, or gaining all.
You and the others chose to
sacrifice. And look at you now.
Not even your glass body is your
own.

STARDUST

For a time. But it will pass. In
the end you will lose all. It will
be your fear that destroys you.

LUCILLE

Ha! Fear? What have I to fear?

STARDUST

You have everything to fear, my
fallen brother. The truth is
light.

Lucille presses in tight, crushing against her glass bones.

Stardust flinches against the pain.

LUCILLE

You creatures of light always
speak of this...

(distaste)

Truth...truth is relative. To you,
the truth is that your life will
soon come to an end. As will the
lives of all those cowards I used
to call family. To me, the truth
is a glorious future, one of power
and pleasure. Paradise.

STARDUST

That is what blinds you, my old
friend. There is but one truth.
One truth that binds our whole
existence. One truth that can get
us where we need to go. Anyone who
promises otherwise is a deceiver,
and speaks not of this truth, but
only of desire.

LUCILLE

Look before you. Look at me.

The dark one wields his hand in an arc.

Lucille appears on Stardust's right side, as if he has been
standing there the whole time. The figure is neither male
nor female. It is both. It is none. It is many.

It flexes its muscles, showing definition and grandeur, but
no veins. No blood. No bones.

The demon's hands and arms are made up of dead roots and
decaying corpses stolen from infant animals.

LUCILLE (CONT'D)

Look at my body. I created it
myself, the way I want it to be.
And I did it without all the
confining laws of that Gen who
seeks to imprison us all. Look on
my power. This is only the
beginning.

STARDUST

(sadness)

Your body is a mockery, brother.
It is empty. Do you think I cannot
see that even now? Even with all
the lights turned out? It is not
the same, and it will end. It must
be. The laws demand it, forgotten
or remembered. The ones you drag

(MORE)

STARDUST (CONT'D)
through the dirt with your
choices. Your new master is not a
father. He is a slaver. A
puppeteer whose strings are false
promises to come. You are his
puppet. Brother if you could only
see the lies the greedy
Morningstar has...

LUCILLE
I will not have you speak of
Morning like that.

Lucille closes his fists, causing Stardust to whimper.

LUCILLE (CONT'D)
And I am not your family. Not
anymore.

Stardust is lifted in rotating suspension. A sudden vice
tightens on her throat. A fracture line shoots down her
glass body.

LUCILLE (CONT'D)
He was once your brother, and
mine. But he rose above. As will
I. He is the greatest of all. He
has only grown stronger since
entering his dominion on this
planet, within this sphere of
power. Don't you realize? Gen
banished Morning and his followers
to this planet, thinking to make
us weaker. Why else would he do
it?

The cracking of Stardust's glass body grows louder with a
crescendo of pain. The whirling sands within her show
contrasting shades as the particles spin furiously.

LUCILLE (CONT'D)
But it didn't make us weaker. It
made us stronger. Gen was wrong.
He is wrong about everything.
Morning entered a realm that your
father fears. My father dared to
conquer darkness. He has mastered
it. He wields it. Just as he said
he would.

The amount of energy in Stardust is now so concentrated
within one point of time and space that the reality of the

mortal realm begins to distort for hundreds of miles in every direction.

LUCILLE (CONT'D)

This is my land and thou art
unwelcome. Mindless follower.
Colorless flower. Fallen star.
Slave.

Boulders break from the walls, falling towards the center where Stardust is floating. Water from the rivers above spew further, roaring loud.

LUCILLE (CONT'D)

We will save the children, all of
them. Except those most loyal to
Gen. Like you.

The light within Stardust diminishes as her contrasting lights swirl frantically.

The dark one cackles.

LUCILLE (CONT'D)

You are weak. Your ideas and your
so-called knowledge are pathetic.
And most of all, your love is an
ancient thing, making you
vulnerable to his power. I cannot
fathom why Morning has let you
continue on for this long. Soon,
your purpose and source will be
destroyed as will your drive to
fight and exist.

The darkness crushes in towards Stardust's center point.

But suddenly, all motion and sound ceases within the abyss. Stardust twitches. Once. Twice.

She slowly unfurls with the careful, deliberate speed of eternal patience. A variant shade reappears within her glass body, which forms facial features in her glass skull.

Stardust's expression is one of disappointment and sorrow.

STARDUST

I had hoped you would be more
penitent after being cast out with
the others, Lucille.

Lucille hisses. His right leg crumbles into dirt and falls away. The dark one stumbles, no longer able to ignore the true state of things.

Stardust sheds two tears at once.

STARDUST (CONT'D)
It appears the opposite is true.
Oh, how quickly you have
forgotten. How far you have
fallen.

Lucille crumbles to inanimate pieces. He gathers his focus and parts, and reappears within the abyss.

He reaches out, bringing together what looks like thousands of long worms and roots, recreating its husk of a body. He attempts to create a body, but fails.

Stardust feels pain for her estranged brother.

The dark one suspends ten feet in front of Stardust, with an umbilical cord leading back to the jagged walls of the abyss.

STARDUST (CONT'D)
You are the one who is weak. Upon
your fall from light, you gave up
your celestial potential for the
promise of this world. You have
been given an illusion of greater
strength, when in fact you have
fallen in more ways than one.

Lucille arches backward, his mouth gaping open to reveal horrible, putrid fangs.

Stardust walks towards him with calmness.

STARDUST (CONT'D)
There are strengths on this planet
that rival that of the celestial
realm. Some were used in the
creation of this planet. Others
lie within the hearts of the
creations themselves. Look at you.
Even now you seek to emulate the
powers of creation. You seek to
bring matter upon yourself, though
you do it in mockery and disgust.

Lucille twitches.

She continues forward and then stops in front of the dark one.

STARDUST (CONT'D)

Not nearly enough souls have yet entered this mortal realm. Your power is weak. Your attempts are reckless. And your failure is sure.

Silence comes.

Then Lucille laughs. His face changes, taking the form of a SPIRIT WOMAN.

LUCILLE

They will come. In their blind obedience, they will come. And in countless, horrific, excruciating, bloody ways, we will take them. Their bodies and spirits and minds. We will ravage them. We will desecrate the bodies they want so badly. We will enter them and rob them. We will kill their souls. And Morning will revere my name for it. He will set me on my own mountain top. That is how I will obtain your coveted glory.

STARDUST

I believe you. And some will follow you willingly. But others will fight. They will fight for the light. The light of Truth. And you will be forgotten. Morning cares for none.

The dark one screams.

LUCILLE

We will conquer their hearts and lead them into our kingdom. They will learn to love it there! The darkness, along with the freedom it provides. To choose it over the shackles of light. And you will never see them again in your precious celestial thrones. And their pain...suffering...it will be...

Lucille bleeds from his face.

LUCILLE (CONT'D)
...delicious.

Stardust explodes in showering light, conquering every crevice of the abyss.

The demon form of the dark one reduces to dark matter, then absolute nothing.

Darkness of all kinds is cast back to the Outside.

The light moves as a great ocean wave, cresting over the lip of the abyss and pouring out over the land. It saturates into the surrounding creations, feeding life back into the bodies of the plants and animals that have suffered from this event.

The dark cloud collapses in on itself and vanishes.

Stardust hangs her head as she ascends towards the sky. She pauses above the surface and looks far over the land.

STARDUST
What a magnificent world she is to
become. Proleum.

Her glass form fades as she rises into the sky.

Yet seeds of darkness remain on the planet.

It will return.

CUT TO:

EXT: HIGH FOREST - NIGHT

Present Day:

Lanterns line an entire path as Ammon, Mikael, Krystal and Bastion start for a stone staircase leading downward.

The partial moon shines from the center of the dark sky.

The illuminating lamps are constructed of sturdy wooden poles with glass lanterns, each housing a large candle.

The group makes their way down the stairs.

AMMON
Do you guys ever think about our
structure of time?

BASTION
Yeah, actually. I've thought of
it, too, though it's been on my
(MORE)

BASTION (CONT'D)
mind more lately. What exactly do
you mean?

KRYSTAL
(to Ammon)
You and your over thinking. Your
logic and numbers. Do you still do
that weird counting thing?

AMMON
You mean how your last sentence
had nine syllables? You bet.

Krystal's eyes roll skyward as she counts the syllables.

She grins and sticks her tongue out at him.

KRYSTAL
I dunno if that's crazy
impressive, or just crazy.

AMMON
Anyway...I've just wondered about
how clean the system is. Year
after year, month after month. All
based on the revolution of stars,
planets, and moons. It fits
perfectly into our numbering
system.

BASTION
Each year made up of forty-eight
weeks and twelve months. Each
month exactly twenty-eight days,
which is the time it takes the
moon to grow full with luster,
then crawl behind shadow once
more.

KRYSTAL
Each week has seven days, which
seem just long enough to work
hard, then rest before lunacy
takes us. Each day containing
twenty-four hours on the dot, from
sunrise to sunrise.

BASTION
The Sun is always rising. There is
always somewhere in the world
where it is rising. Like a tidal
wave of warmth, life, and hope
continuously sweeping the planet.

KRYSTAL

So deep.

AMMON

But it is. Come now. A world
without light would be no world at
all.

MIKAEL

I like how our weeks are set up,
too. The structure is...nice. I
dunno. The routine makes it easier
somehow.

They continue east along the path. The only lights in the region come from the lanterns and sky.

Their planet Proelum spins on its own axis, causing the stars to appear ever-drifting like pond fish.

The lights of the Leviticum come into view. The entire structure is a perfect circle that stretches upward for seven floors.

Cobble steps lining the path at random intervals.

BASTION

Race ya.

Bastion sprints past Ammon.

AMMON

That's not even fair. I ran up
Cloud today!

Ammon leaps forward.

He beats Bastion to the top. Both boys collapse in the grass.

They hear Mikael and Krystal approaching.

Ammon and Bastion stand as they step onto the cobbled path which creeps from the trees and to the Leviticum entrance.

All four friends stand still on the path shoulder, their noses raised to the sky. Then a light catches their eyes.

They turn toward a glowing yellow entity just to the north of the Leviticum.

Beneath the distinct voices from the Wind Caves comes a deep tone of thumping music.

They step off towards the Wind Caves as one, following the chords of light.

Both caves are gaping eye sockets. A crowd of Cephasonians are blended as if part of the landscape themselves.

Ammon spots a familiar face that brings instant dread. CHALICE AMBER, an irritating and unpleasant young man to be around.

BASTION
There's Chalice.

AMMON
The ass who pulls hermit crabs
from their shells and smashes
their homes.

BASTION
I could have murdered him.

AMMON
I knocked him unconscious.

Standing next to Chalice is his best friend, MAISON, two years younger, quiet, polite and mild. These traits in themselves are good things, but in Maison, they're worrisome.

Chalice has his arm around a younger girl named LEILANI and notices the group approaching them. He snickers and whispers something in her ear.

They both chuckle and look towards Ammon and his friends.

CHALICE
My favorite degenerates! What
brings you here this fine evening?

BASTION
Oh, we heard some sounds
called...music? We thought we
would check it out. Is it some
kind of party?

All but Chalice and Maison laugh. Leilani covers her dimpled face with her arm.

The smug grin on Chalice's face vanishes as Maison stands several paces behind him, seeming disinterested.

Ammon looks into the distant eyes of Maison. Noticing the hood he's wearing, Ammon also notices something in his stare.

He snaps back to the present moment, realizing he is in the center of an awkward silence.

CHALICE

Well, can't say I blame you. I wouldn't be preparing for the Sector Guard Trials either, if I were you. Not since Maison and I are entertaining, which leaves zero chances for you to be accepted.

KRYSTAL

What's your deal, man?

CHALICE

My deal, as you have so eloquently put it, my dear, is that you children have been following in my footsteps ever since we grew apart as kids.

KRYSTAL

Following in your...You've got to be kidding me.

CHALICE

What else would you call it, then? I start going to Master Bozolf's class to learn about Worlds, and soon after, all five of you do the exact same thing.

KRYSTAL

Everyone takes that class!

AMMON

I'm sure Chalice knows we joined the class much later. He must also know that we joined the class long after we joined Master Kodin's class, which is the counterpart to Bozolf's Worlds class. He most definitely knows that every such course in the Leviticum is organized with two opposing parts. And I suspect he also knows that literally every other interest we have, despite this one, differs greatly.

Ammon glares at Chalice, challenging him.

He can't stop himself.

AMMON (CONT'D)

I also suspect that he's quite ignorant of why we joined Bozolf's class, which was in fact by recommendation of Master Kodin. But alas, we should move on, lest we completely exhaust the tiny collection that is Chalice's knowledge of things. Strange, using the word 'knowledge' when referring to you, my dear, dear child.

The group snickers at their comments, all except Maison who stands in the background, arms folded and motionless.

CHALICE

You are wrong about one thing. We have one other common interest, you and I.

Chalice grins at Ammon. He knows what Chalice means.

AMMON

Yeah, well. Lucky for me, she only likes real men, not weak boys. And further, she looks upon the heart of a person. And I suspect yours is rather unpleasant to behold. And say you did have a change of heart in the future? Well, your face should still be enough to scare her away.

CHALICE

Like I said, following in my footsteps, you and the other Delkai spawn will no doubt chase me to the Trials of Guardians. But be you warned, it will just be a waste of your time. And who knows, you may even hurt yourselves.

Ammon turns and begins to walk away, waving off Chalice and heading towards the Wind Caves.

Krystal gives Chalice the shoulder as she passes him.

Mikael and Bastion catch up with them as they stand outside the Wind Caves.

EXT: WIND CAVES - CONT

There is a crowd of chaos. The energy is high. Music from the caves ring at full throttle as a band plays.

A performer, VIOLA sings as two brothers, TSUSANI and TANK play instruments.

A wind blows gently in the cave as the music reaches everyone in the crowd.

Ammon pushes forward, forcing himself through the thick crowds.

He makes it to the front line just as the performance ends. A MAN approaches him.

MAN
Son of Delkai?

Ammon nods to him.

MAN (CONT'D)
You're up after the next
performance.

Clearly anxious, Ammon hops over the front gate and walks towards to the sides of the caves, catching several eyes as he walks behind the cave stages.

He joins many people holding instruments in their hands.

Ammon finds his acoustic guitar with redwood tints. He smiles at it before picking it up.

He hears the crowd as another song comes on. Ammon plays through his own song one last time, muting the strings with his palm.

He takes a deep breath after another round of applause.

Ammon walks to the back of the large cave, looking up at the treeline of the North Hills. He smiles at nature before him.

Feeling dizzy for a moment, he holds himself steady with a hand on the rock wall.

An echo runs through the air.

ECHO (O.S.)
We will see how he understands...

Ammon shakes his head, refocusing on the present. He breathes a more steady breath before stepping off onto the stage.

A hesitant cheer rings out as Ammon walks up to the front of the cave mouth.

Searching for the faces of his friends, Ammon looks down at his guitar and pretends to tune it. His hands are trembling.

Then his hands grow steady.

Ammon strums the opening arrangement of chords. It's as pleasant and simple as a gentle wave. He continues to strum, carrying the crowd with him.

Changing the chord progression, the song sets a new tone. Ammon brings lyrics to the song and begins to speak.

AMMON

(speaking)

Intelligence is light. There are different glories, all emanating from this one central source that reaches through everything. One level of intelligence is but one level of light. Every light casts a shadow. This shadow, birthed of light, may be the one that finds itself larger than its creator. The shadow grows when a hardened substance approaches the light. The shadow might then rebel, only to extinguish what brought it into being. And if so, then so it would go, complete darkness would rule.

Ammon plays a quick refrain, finding new comfort upon the stage.

AMMON (CONT'D)

Creation began with a single word.

The guitar strings reverberate off the walls. He speaks again with low resonance.

AMMON (CONT'D)

This word was a promise, connecting all things. Such a word cannot be recited in any one language. It takes all coming together as one, just as it was in the beginning. However, this word can be understood, in part, with a story. This story has never been

(MORE)

AMMON (CONT'D)
heard by ears other than one, as
well as the ears of the wind
itself.

Ammon feels the music.

AMMON (CONT'D)
It is time for the word to return.
The first word spoken into
existence echoed energy into all
that we know. This single word
spoke to all things. It spoke
thus...

He gradually increases the tempo and volume of his
strumming, rising slowly as he walks up the bank of the cave
to his left.

As he drifts, the acoustics shift into a happier tune.

While strumming with one part of his mind and forming chords
with another, he separates his mind into a third part
without thinking.

Panic arises within him.

Ammon closes his eyes, resting his mind. He strums faster,
feeling the pulse of the crowd follow along.

His eyes slowly open, then settle upon the face of Sadie,
the girl from the Cephasonian family, near the front of the
crowd.

A warm smile spreads across Ammon's lips.

He feels energized as the end of the song approaches and
echoes all around him.

The last chord from Ammon's guitar echoes with his last
spoken words.

AMMON (CONT'D)
We are one.

There is a shift in the air. A strong wind blankets the
crowd.

Ammon can feel it coming over him.

The crowd erupts with applause.

He hears somewhere in the echo of his mind the voice again.

ECHO (O.S.)
He did it. He is beginning to
understand.

Ammon bows to the audience.

Heading for backstage, Ammon exits and turns a corner.

The resonating sound of cheers cease entirely. The contrast
is startling.

Ammon notices a vibration in his left hand, which still
holds the guitar neck.

He looks over the guitar, tracing its oak body, its strings
made from the fragile veins of tree leaves.

Krystal, Mikael and Bastion appear just then, interrupting
this mystery.

MIKAEL
Ammon! Where did you even practice
that?

AMMON
But I've been practicing all week.

MIKAEL
Yeah, right. Not that song. What
is it called?

KRYSTAL
The song with a happy ending.

AMMON
The song of all happy endings,
sweet child.

Ammon bows.

They both laugh.

BASTION
Yeah wow, best by far.

MIKAEL
Where did you come up with the
material?

AMMON
You know all those books I've been
bringing home from the Leviticum
lately? Well, each of those held a
smidgeon of the story. After
reading two or three of them, I
(MORE)

AMMON (CONT'D)
 began to see a common thread
 between them all. I sought more of
 this thread in other books, pieced
 it together, filled in the gaps,
 then added a bit of romance to the
 end.

Mikael tilts his head.

MIKAEL
 Yeah, but wasn't that the theme of
 the whole song from the beginning?
 A romanticized creation of
 Proleum, with a conclusion of two
 hearts becoming one again. Almost
 like...balance..being restored....

Everyone wears poorly-concealed grins on their faces as they
 watch Mikael.

KRYSTAL
 You may be thinkin' 'bout this too
 much there, cutie.

Krystal grabs Mikael's arm.

He chuckles.

MIKAEL
 Hey, its his story. He's the one
 who created it.

AMMON
 It's ours.

BASTION
 And the wind called to you.

They all grow quiet at once.

BASTION (CONT'D)
 Legend says that when the wind is
 called, everyone nearby hears it
 too, though its meaning is unique
 to each person. Elements speak not
 the language of men, but rather
 that of planets and truth. They
 speak to the hearts of things.

KRYSTAL
 Hmmm. The words were weird.
 Afterwards though, I had another
 voice inside, as if a translation.
 (MORE)

KRYSTAL (CONT'D)
It said, "Trust your true
friends"...

Bastion looks aghast.

BASTION
You aren't supposed to tell
anyone!

KRYSTAL
Oh stahp. Hell, the message is to
trust you guys. So that's what I'm
doing.

BASTION
You know what else they say? If
the wind calls directly to you, it
gives you a piece of its heart
forever. And in turn, it becomes a
part of you, and you a part of it.

Krystal laughs aloud.

KRYSTAL
Wow! And I thought I was the girl
of this group. Listen to you boys.

Viola steps up from behind Ammon, giving him a huge hug
around his waist.

Ammon turns towards her before giving an exaggerated bow and
a kiss on the top of her right hand.

VIOLA
Your story was lovely, Ammon. The
melodious intro. The quick turn to
dark beginnings. That battle, the
restoration of hope. And then,
deliverance! Man and woman, bound
for each other, two halves of a
greater whole, coming together to
create new life...

Krystal rolls her eyes.

AMMON
Ahhh yes, it was quite fun to
perform. But what about you? We
walked up right as you were
beginning your ballad. It was
marvelous! The way you three
complement each other with almost
every note, all with the tender
passion of playing your
(MORE)

AMMON (CONT'D)
instruments...Your skills are
forever beyond me.

VIOLA
Hmmm. Maybe. We surely did enjoy
ourselves. But Ammon. The wind
called to you. I dare say it was
the most beautiful calling of our
time. And the words it spoke to
me...I would venture to say I
almost understood its meaning. I
have never felt such peace before.
Never ever. And it was all thanks
to you.

Viola kisses Ammon on his cheek.

VIOLA (CONT'D)
Seeya 'round.

Her eyes linger on Ammon as he watches her walk away.

Krystal slaps the back of Ammon's head.

SADIE (O.S.)
Ammon!

Sadie runs up to the group.

KRYSTAL
Oh for crying out loud.

SADIE
There's my superstar! Nice of you
to come down and mingle with us
normal people. I thought you had
finally taken your place in the
sky.

AMMON
Oh come on now, don't be like
that.

Ammon smiles and nudges Sadie gently.

KRYSTAL
We'll meet you down at the Lake of
Light.

AMMON
Sounds good.

Krystal, Mikael and Bastion head off.

Sadie hugs Ammon when they leave.

SADIE

I can't believe you. You already have it all. And then you go ahead and summon the wind, no big deal. Like you two were old friends. Never mind that it's only one of the seven elements. It's not fair to the rest of us mortals.

AMMON

Oh whatever.

She releases her grip on him.

Ammon takes her hand as they follow the group from a distance.

SADIE

So did you like, hear this song in a dream or something? Did you write it while floating on the backs of turtles, surfing the waves of life?

AMMON

None too dramatic as that. Nor as cool. No it was more like several nights without sleep in the Index, searching for books about the history of our planet. I did my best to find things both factual and poetic. Turns out, it was mostly poetic.

SADIE

Whatever it was, the wind liked it.

AMMON

Have you ever looked into the birth of Proelum?

SADIE

You know how unbearably condescending Master Bozolf can be. I remember his courses about chance. How the odds of our world forming out of nothing from a spontaneous reaction were almost zero. How even my existence and your existence right now depended upon the survival of all of our ancestors, and how that also is a

(MORE)

SADIE (CONT'D)
miraculous coincidence. I dunno, I
don't like to think about that
stuff too much. Not the whys. It
just was. Its hurts my head.

She laughs and squeezes Ammon's hand.

CUT TO:

EXT: LAKE OF LIGHT - NIGHT

The moon is high in the sky as the group approaches the Lake of Light.

Music beckons them from the Lake.

It is here that Ammon takes his queue. He holds Sadie at the waist and pulls her into the trees. They start to dance.

Both behave a bit silly as they move between fireflies and other couples gliding by.

The closer they draw to the Lake, the thicker the trunks of the trees become.

They drift closer and then further apart, moving together in the light.

Then the trees open to water. Light showers upon them in a billion glorious degrees. The water is translucent and clear. Suspended within are minuscule particles of limestone and glowing insects, creating blue-green shades.

There are scattered groups of Cephasonians all throughout the Lake. Several trees anchor themselves in the water, providing high roots for the young people to sit upon, or jump from.

Frogs, turtles and even salamanders, minnows and axolotls join those floating in the waters.

Ammon looks toward the source of the music. A small stage is against a rock wall to the North Hills, which rises straight upwards.

They spot Viola and Tsusani holding hands tenderly.

Ammon turns to Sadie and gazes upon her. He reaches out and holds her hand, too. She squeezes back.

Sadie tugs him gently and leads him to the waters. Together, they sink their shoulders, gliding their hands back and forth as the music from the rock wall continues.

Ammon and Sadie's fingers tough as they catch each other's hands.

He kisses her cheek.

Sadie pulls Ammon under the water, both sinking to the shallow bottom. Sound is muted.

She kisses him underneath the water.

Coming back up for air, they smile at each other. Ammon kisses her other cheek.

Sadie looks back to the trees.

SADIE

Elizabeth is over there waiting
for me. She wanted to talk to me
about something. Probably her date
with your brother.

AMMON

Yeah, I should probably get going
too.

They lean forward and kiss each others lips.

Ammon watches her drift off to find Elizabeth.

As the music comes to completion, Ammon shifts his eyes to the stage as a figure steps out.

Ammon heads to land to meet up with Mikael, Krystal and Bastion.

EXT: STAGE - CONT

A man named VOTHEK THE STORYTELLER stands on the stage with a serious face, but playful eyes.

The group gathers around to listen.

VOKETH

The story of the Angel Killer is
the oldest of the land. To some,
it is true. Others call it legend.
Some say it happened long ago,
before Proelum was flooded with
fire, nay, even before it was
flooded with water. Each of you
must decide what you believe. For
that is life. Such is the purpose.
Such is living. Come. Follow me.

EXT: LAND - DAY

Flashback:

A YOUNG BOY stands amongst the old lands of Proleum from many years ago.

VOKETH (V.O.)

Once there was a normal boy. He lived on what seemed to be normal land. But it was not a normal land, nor was he a normal boy. The land was a blessed land. As long as those who lived in the land followed the covenants bound to it, they would prosper in all aspects of life. This was not to say that life would be easy, for such a thing could never exist. Such a thing would break universal law, after all. Yet ultimately all people would prosper, if they just endured to the end.

The face of the Young Boy transforms into a YOUNG MAN.

VOKETH (V.O.) (CONT'D)

The boy was also blessed. He was born a normal boy, with the potential to do great things. Whether these things would be good or evil, or both, was up to him. As he grew up he did normal things, learning little by little of the world around him. One night in his young adulthood, he had a dream. It beckoned him to leave his land. And so he did, saying goodbye to all that he loved.

The Young Man starts to walk the fields of the land.

He disappears over the horizon as the world turns dark.

VOKETH (V.O.) (CONT'D)

Years passed. Decades. The world became a darker place, and evil spread throughout the land. As the darkness rose up like a tsunami, the boy returned.

Many years have passed as the Young Man, now taller and leaner, though mostly the same, comes up the hill.

VOKETH (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 He appeared as a normal boy, and
 all recognized him for who he used
 to be.

Crowds of people gather around as the Young Man approaches them.

Aged folks and parents hold onto their children.

VOKETH (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 His parents were ancient, his
 friends all now parents of their
 own. But the boy appeared mostly
 unchanged. He was more cheerful,
 brighter. More innocent, if that
 were possible. And so it was.

The Young Man stands in front of them all.

VOKETH (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 Then, a look crossed his eyes as
 he peered into the darkness.

He kneels down and places his palm on the dirt beneath him.

The lands begins to shake.

VOKETH (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 There began a great shift in the
 land. All could feel it, though
 none knew what it was. Some said
 it felt as if he were reaching
 into the heart of the planet
 itself.

Seconds tick by and the darkness falls upon the boy who now appears to be a MIGHTY MAN. A face appears in the shadows, as if to swallow the Mighty Man who is standing.

A light comes out of the ground, like a seed being pulled from the soil, its young roots receding into its shell as if to condense its power.

The Mighty Man stands, looks back at his people, and smiles.

And then, he swallows the radiant seedling.

Immediately, light pours from his eyes and mouth. His body lifts from the ground and glows brighter and brighter until none can look upon him, nor look away, for he is everywhere.

A YOUNG WOMAN watches him.

VOKETH (V.O.) (CONT'D)

There was one present who kept her
eyes open the longest, gazing
directly at his body. Her account
is the only one that exists.

A pillar of fire descends upon the rock before the Mighty
Man. They speak, though no words are heard.

All matter surrounding him begins to vibrate, then fuse.

His shape is gone, though his presence remains. There is
lightning, wind beckoning, rocks rising and falling. Time
skips through forgotten frames. Water pours down, then fire.

There is a roar from beasts all around, and then...

Silence. Absolute silence.

There are suddenly rumbling and blasts that seem to go on
for eternity. The Young Woman can't help but look away.

And then it was gone.

Silence again.

Everyone in the crowds looks up to see their familiar world,
quiet as a land after storm.

They can see the boy again. He looks normal.

VOKETH (V.O.) (CONT'D)

It was from this account that
people began to speak. They retold
the story, saying the boy absorbed
the light, then used it to
vanquish the evil. In doing so,
however, he killed the light, in
order to kill the darkness. Both
the light and the dark were
angels, and he killed them. The
boy was first revered, then
feared. And soon, he was cast out,
then sought after for execution.
But they never found him again.

The boy disappears.

VOKETH (V.O.) (CONT'D)

The darkness was gone from the
land, but not from their hearts.
The world had seen a change that
day, though it mostly remained
unchanged itself.

An OLD MAN watches from where the boy had been standing.

VOKETH (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 The real trick of it all comes
 from another man, who was a
 visitor to this Last Land where
 angels were killed. He had been
 there for a year, and had received
 no hint of kindness. He tells the
 story of seeing the wave as the
 light, and the boy as a demon,
 summoning shadows from the dark
 center of the world to combat the
 light. Such a perfectly opposing
 tale makes one wonder what sort of
 angels were defeated that day.

End of flashback.

EXT: LEVITICUM - NIGHT

Present day:

Ammon, Mikael, Krystal and Bastion all laugh and jest as they approach the Leviticum building.

Above the main doors is the quote written in gold letters that read, "Remember who you are, within you live true potential. You are all little worlds, within you the Sun, the Moon, the Stars."

They enter the Leviticum.

INT: LEVITICUM - CONT

The group enters the main corridor as they take the first door to the left and continue forward.

Lamps and candles are scattered throughout, yet darkness prevails within the open chamber and towering book shelves.

INT: STUDY ROOM - CONT

Ammon enters a secluded room meant for groups to read or study and finds his younger friend, JONAH, pressing one final button on a glisc projector.

JONAH
 Hey, there you are! Oh man, are we
 in for a treat tonight!

Bastion, Krystal and Mikael pour in as Jonah continues.

JONAH (CONT'D)

I bypassed the volume control for the speakers while adding a few other wireless parts. Needless to say, the room will shake. And the best part is...

Jonah points to a pile of rolled-up foam beds in the corner.

JONAH (CONT'D)

We have hi-tech sound proofing technology.

AMMON

Hey now! Nice job Jonah. This is slick.

BASTION

Yeah, nice job Jonah. Now give us the tasty treats.

Bastion falls into a large corner couch and kicks his feet up.

KRYSTAL

Don't be a jerk.

Krystal swings her pack around while tossing out small bags of snacks.

KRYSTAL (CONT'D)

Tonight was my night for treats. And listen. I know it looks a little weird, but my friend Gyana from the Gardens got me some of this new fruit they are growing. It tastes delightful. Gives you a boost of energy, too. So no sleeping for us tonight!

MIKAEL

Woop woop!

BASTION

You have friends?

KRYSTAL

I have good and bad friends, of which you are clearly of the latter.

AMMON

Jonah, where did you get all this foam anyway?

JONAH

Well, you see, a few of our
favorite people may have left
their cube doors unlocked, and I
may or may not have snagged their
-

Krystal punches Jonah's arm.

JONAH (CONT'D)

Hey!

KRYSTAL

You stole them?!

JONAH

Borrowed them! We will put them
right back in the morning, no big
deal.

Everyone takes a seat in a foam mattress.

Jonah pauses and smiles wide, his eyes huge and peering at
each of them.

JONAH (CONT'D)

You guys ready?

He presses a button and a sudden fanfare of brass
instruments shatter the sound barrier.

They smother their ears with nearby blankets and pillows.

Everyone screams.

CUT TO:

INT: LEVITICUM - LATER

The movie is over and everyone is passed out on their foam
mattresses.

Ammon has fallen into another dream.

CUT TO:

INT: DREAM - CONT

Ammon awakes in his dream on the island of Ilan.

It's dark. His body is not his own. He stands inside a
masculine body belonging to a young man named MATTEO (16).

He watches as a storm materializes from nowhere. It's tearing his island to shreds, whipping his long, brown hair back.

Matteo watches as a figure steps from the shadows. At first it is a woman, but she then transforms into a PANTHER.

As it grows closer, its odd shapes and angles seem off. It carries with it a smell of decay. Matteo covers his nose.

PANTHER

Don't be childish. You will adapt,
as you already have. You will
learn to love the smell, or else
not even notice it. Come, young
one. There is a storm approaching.
You are right to want more, there
is so much more to this world that
they hide from you. Your parents,
your leaders. Even your friends.
They're all liars. The storm will
come and fix everything.

Matteo watches the STORM now. The thundering clouds. The rouge winds and waves. The giant glowing beast in the sky, screeching to all.

In the cries, Matteo can hear the voice of the Storm speak.

STORM

Come to me, child. Accept new
power. You are the one.

He steps from the trees. The winds blast him, but Matteo holds firm.

STORM

You have been chosen by Lord
Morning, the future ruler of all
we spoke about. You are to wield
the new stone.

There are two glowing lights in the sky, one violet and one emerald.

With a thundering clap and a deafening cry, the violet seems to consume the green light.

A DARK CREATURE forms from wisps of dark cloud, descending down upon the sacred sands next to a blackened tree.

The Dark Creature walks towards Matteo, holding him in his eyes. Ammon recognizes the figure, Venetia, the woman's body

he had possessed in another dream. She watches Matteo before holding out her hand.

Darkness swirls back to reveal the same green glow she has just consumed. She holds out the heart of Illan, in the form of a glowing stone, jagged and unrefined.

VENETIA

And who will wield this Stone for
Morning?

He stares at the stone.

Matteo turns toward the Storm and Venetia.

MATTEO

And what of my family and friends?

VENETIA

My boy. It is the way of things.
Come with me, and we will give you
power. You will find new strength
with us. New family, new friends.
In this, you will save the world.
In this, you do what is best and
rise above.

Anger grows within Matteo as he clenches his fists.

VENETIA (CONT'D)

You will see your family again, if
you will come with me. You are
doing this all for them, even if
it means hurting them at first.

Venetia smiles at him.

She transforms back into a Panther, stepping forward with a paw.

The entire island shakes under her weight, knocking Matteo to his knees.

As Venetia takes a step back, there is a new glow in the sand. It is the same emerald glow from before, buried inches in the ground.

It is the heart of his island. The heart of Ilan.

VENETIA (CONT'D)

Come unto me, Matteo. Let us take
on the world together.

Matteo plunges his fist into the sands, grasping the Stone.
He screams in pain.

The Stone fights back, but he holds on.

Matteo swallows the power of the Stone. He can feel the mass
in his chest.

CUT TO:

INT: OUTER DARKNESS - NIGHT

Matteo stands before his master MORNING in the Outer
Darkness where there is no light.

He smiles whilst kneeling to him.

MATTEO

Matteo is dead. I am now
Conqueror.

MORNING

And here she comes.

Blood curdling screams rip from the new Stone-bearer. Her
figure lies in the center of the twelve. It is a woman
writhing in agony.

A wave of power blasts from her Stone of Energy, blinding
all and reducing two of the weakest demons to dust.

Venetia, the Prison of Voids, stands by Moringstar's side.

Morningstar laughs manically.

MORNINGSTAR

My beloved. Do you understand what
has just happened? Never, in the
history of all Proelum, have we
progressed so rapidly as we are
now. Gaze before you.

A crunch and a cry sounds as Morningstar stomps deep into
the chest of the new Stone-bearer.

MORNINGSTAR (CONT'D)

She shall be the receptacle for
our latest achievement. We have
found and destroyed the hidden one
of Energy. The island called
Ethera, burrowed thousands of feet
deep under bedrock. It was once a
cavern filled with flora and fauna
of dapted luminescence, all
pitifully futile things that are
(MORE)

MORNINGSTAR (CONT'D)
now dead and buried, filled in
with sweet darkness. The island
was the space of nourishing air,
surrounded by a sea of compacted
soils. This woman here led the
charge with feats unparalleled in
one so beautiful. For twenty-four
years she lived amongst her
people, never feeling like they
were her own. Knowing that there
had to be something more to all
this.

Morningstar raises his arms. Matteo winces at his words.

MORNINGSTAR (CONT'D)
I'm sure many of you can relate.

He pushes harder on the Woman, shooting sparks in all
directions.

MORNINGSTAR (CONT'D)
She led us to her island and to it
we led a flood through the Stone
of Water. Drowning performed
admirably. He is already in
pursuit of another, the very Stone
of Matter. So again, I ask you. Do
you understand what has just
happened? We are moving at an
unprecedented rate. Far quicker
than when we kindled the world for
its great burning. By taking this
new Stone of Energy, for the first
time in over a thousand years, we
hold the upper hand! This is to
speak of numbers alone, for we
know that we will triumph in the
end. Four of the Seven. Alas, we
have momentum. Water, Voids,
Dominion, and now, Energy. Through
these, we are creeping further
into the mortal world. And through
these, we will devour and control
it, to bring matter to our own.

Matteo and the rest scream in a battle cry.

MORNINGSTAR (CONT'D)
Yes! My promises to you all will
be fulfilled, and we will all be
much closer to our dream. Keep up
this momentum. Seek out the Stones
of Matter, Gravity, and Rest. Do
(MORE)

MORNINGSTAR (CONT'D)
not slow. Do not be diminished. Do
not let us down.

Morningtstar stomps one last time on her chest, and vanishes from their space.

CUT TO:

INT: STUDY ROOM - CONT

Ammon jerks awake.

He looks around the study room of the Leviticum. The projector is off. The room is quiet and peaceful.

CUT TO:

INT: LEVITICUM - CONT

Ammon walks out of the study room and into the hall.

He heads for the elevator.

Pressing it the glowing green button on the wall, the elevator is there in seconds.

Stumbling in, he pushes the button for the first floor. He rubs his eyes.

He notices the elevator going up.

Looking at the numbered buttons, he can see only the 1 glowing brightly.

The elevator slows and stops on the seventh floor.

The transparent glass doors creep open. He can sense someone is there.

He scans the environment for movement in the dark hall. Are those glowing eyes?

VOICE (O.S.)
Leave this place. Leave. Before
they follow.

The elevator doors lurch and seal shut.

Ammon gasps and falls back. The elevator goes back down.

The doors slide open on the third floor revealing Mastor Lyon holding a lantern.

MASTER LYON

Ammon. Why in the world are you awake?

AMMON

Good evening, Master. My friends and I fell asleep in the study rooms again. I'm just making my way back to my cube to get some good sleep.

He steps into the elevator.

MASTER LYON

Ahhh. You know, I used to do that with my own friends, including your father, Erik. That was decades ago, of course, but the memories are still strong. Anyway, sorry to startle you. You probably didn't expect to see anyone yourself.

The elevator heads down again.

Master Lyon holds the lantern up to Ammon's face.

MASTER LYON (CONT'D)

You look very awake for how late it is. Are you doing okay?

AMMON

I'm fine, Master. Just a bit nervous I suppose.

Master Lyon nods.

MASTER LYON

Sleep is a wonderful thing. Most nights it comes easy. Some nights, however, it can be quite elusive. Especially when our minds weigh heavy with worry.

AMMON

Why are you up this late, Master?

MASTER LYON

A good question, of which I can only give a partial answer. In my dream, this is where I walked. So when I awoke, I concluded this was where I should be.

There's a silence as Ammon considers telling him of his own dreams.

MASTER LYON (CONT'D)
Perhaps you are wondering why I didn't wait until tomorrow morning. Another good question. However, for this one, I can give you a complete answer. I have found throughout my life that as I receive promptings for action, it is best to act as soon as possible. After all, tomorrow is promised to no one.

The elevator opens to the first floor.

They both step out together and walk down the hall.

MASTER LYON (CONT'D)
You have quite a significant day approaching. Are you prepared?

AMMON
Yes, I think so. As prepared as I will ever be. I've been waiting for this moment for a long time.

MASTER LYON
You will do just fine, Ammon. You have good parents and a good heart. I have no doubt that you will end up exactly where you belong.

Ammon reaches the passage to the corridor and turns to thank Master Lyon, but he has stopped already.

He looks ready to say something.

MASTER LYON (CONT'D)
Stay true to what you believe is right. If you do this, then no matter which path you take, you will end up where you need to go. And where you need to go will become where you want to go. Similar to the little adventure I expect you had tonight.

Master Lyon smiles at Ammon.

Fade Out:

THE END